

How deep is the ocean?

The deepest part of the ocean is 7 miles (11 km) under water. Just like on dry land, the ocean floor has mountains and valleys. The deepest parts are called trenches. Not much lives at these cold, dark depths, but there is much more life in the zones above.

Quick quiz



What is an ocean trench?



Which zone has the most sea life?



How do scientists reach the ocean floor?

Sunlit sea.....

The top zone is the sunlit zone, where sunlight reaches 650 ft (200 m) down into the clear, blue water. Most sea life lives here, where there is plenty of food. Scuba divers can safely explore to depths of around 165 ft (50 m).

Murky twilight.....

The next level, down to 3,300 ft (1,000 m), is called the twilight zone. Fewer fishes and sea creatures live here, where the sea is darker and colder.

Dark waters

The dark zone drops from 3,300–13,000 ft (1,000–4,000 m). Only deep-sea fishes and animals can survive in these cold waters, where there is less chance of finding food.

